

Connection Q&A Notes

Companion notes for Replay 2 · Emotional Wellness and Connection · every tool from the whiteboard, plus space for the transcript highlights

The verbatim transcript of the live call is generated from the recording after editing and appended to this document. These notes hold every tool drawn on the whiteboard so the replay is usable without the transcript. Participant stories are anonymized; no outcome claims.

Support first

If anything in the replay brings up more than you can hold: your doctor, your clinic's counsellor, your country's crisis line, RESOLVE (US), Fertility Network (UK), or a therapist listing fertility or perinatal mental health. Reaching out is one of the tools. Distress on this journey is common enough that clinics are advised to screen for it (ESHRE guideline, Gameiro et al., *Human Reproduction*). Pre-treatment distress did not predict treatment outcome (Boivin et al., *BMJ*): your anxiety did not cause a negative test.

Whiteboard 1 · We grieve differently

Two arrows: **talk / be held** and **plan / fix / go quiet**, meeting at **say it out loud**. Neither style is wrong; each reads the other as not caring. Sentences to say on a good day: "When I'm upset I need you to listen, not fix." / "When I go quiet I'm processing; ask me in an hour." Men's distress on this journey is often unspoken; ask, then listen.

Whiteboard 2 · The listening loop (Module 6)

Attention → reflect → check → one open question → reflect again. The most useful sentence: "**Listening or ideas?**" The three enemies: fixing, defending, matching. The two-minute empathy exercise from the call: one speaks about the last hard week; the other only reflects and checks; debrief: "What was it like to be reflected instead of fixed?"

Whiteboard 3 · The coping plan for the negative test (Module 4)

PART	BUILT LIVE WITH THE GROUP
Emotion	grief and fear
Trigger	the morning of

PART

BUILT LIVE WITH THE GROUP

In my body	hollow chest
First tool	three physiological sighs
Second tool	a walk within the hour
Who I'll tell, and the sentence	partner, tonight: "I need you to just be with me"
What I'll say to myself	"This month, not forever."
A boundary	no baby shower this weekend

Your own: fill the Emotion Wheel PDF template.

Whiteboard 4 · The habit fight (Module 6)

Soft start-up → "I" statement ("I feel... when... because... I'd like...") → listen → flooded? → 20 minutes apart → return → repair ("Can we start over?") → one small agreement → one gratitude each. Gottman: the first three minutes predict the ending; contempt is the strongest predictor of trouble; a structured break and a return beats pushing on; five positives to one negative.

Extended family

Boundaries are preparation, not rudeness. "We're not discussing timelines, but we'd love your help with Sunday dinner." Leave the shower early. Mute the account.

Doing this alone

Your circle is your partner: a friend, sibling, parent, the person from the forum. Every practice works the same. Say who your person is; if you don't have one yet, say that.

Integration

Stress hormones dampen the brain's signals to the ovaries and testes (Module 4); connection raises oxytocin and lowers stress markers (Module 6). The heart work is body work.

Homework (from the call)

- ☐ One ten-minute listening session this week ("something about this journey I haven't said")
- ☐ One coping plan, written calm, for the situation I fear most
- ☐ One gratitude tonight, at the pillow

Watch and reflect (10 XP) · Apply one tip and post the result (10 XP).

Transcript highlights (appended after editing)

TIMESTAMP	THEME	KEY POINT

Participant breakthroughs (anonymized, in their own words)

Educational content only, not medical advice. Always consult your doctor or a qualified health professional before changing supplements, diet, exercise or detox practices, especially while trying to conceive.